

Lesson Notes – Scenes

Lesson Introduction

Definition; A scene is a place where an incident in real life or fiction occurs. Scenes apply in creating animations, conversations, etc. In Scratch, a **scene** is the **backdrop** that shows where your story, game, or animation takes place.

- Changing scenes helps make projects more **interesting** and **fun**.
- You can switch between scenes to show different places, times of day, or parts of a story.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, learners will be able to:

1. Identify the **stage/backdrop** in Scratch.
2. Add and change **backdrops (scenes)** in a project.
3. Use blocks to **switch between scenes** during a project.
4. Combine **scenes with sprites and events** to tell a story or build a game.
5. Understand how changing scenes makes a project more **interactive and engaging**.

Key Vocabulary

- **Scene / Backdrop:** The background where your sprites appear.
- **Switch Backdrop:** Scratch block used to change the scene.
- **Next Backdrop:** Scratch block used to move to the next backdrop in the list.
- **Event:** Something that triggers a change, like starting the project or clicking a sprite.

Step-by-Step Guided Activity

Step 1: Set Up

1. Open Scratch 3 and click **Create**.
2. Add a sprite of your choice (e.g., Cat).
3. Add **two or more backdrops** from the backdrop library.

Step 2: Switch Scenes on Green Flag

1. Click on the **Stage** and select the **Code tab**.
2. Add the following script:

```
when green flag clicked  
switch backdrop to [City]  
say "Welcome to the City!" for 2 seconds
```

The project starts with the City scene when the green flag is clicked.

Step 3: Switch Scenes Using Broadcast

1. Add a second backdrop (e.g., Forest).
2. Add a broadcast message in the sprite script:

when this sprite clicked
broadcast [GoToForest]

3. Make the Stage respond to the broadcast:

when I receive [GoToForest]
switch backdrop to [Forest]
say "Now we are in the Forest!" for 2 seconds

Clicking the sprite changes the scene from City to Forest.

Step 4: Optional Enhancements

- Add **sounds** when changing scenes.
- Add more sprites that **react differently in each scene**.
- Use **Next Backdrop** to create a sequence of scenes for a story.
- Add a **timer variable** to automatically switch scenes after a few seconds.

Example:

With guidance, help students come up with a project showing a person around the city, showing different scenes and what happens there.

Discussion / Questions

1. What is a scene in Scratch?
2. How do you change a scene using the Stage?
3. How can broadcast messages help in changing scenes?
4. How can you make a story more exciting using multiple scenes?
5. Can you combine changing scenes with sprite animations?

Learning Outcome

By the end of this lesson, learners will be able to:

- Use **backdrops to create scenes** in Scratch projects.
- **Switch scenes** using the Stage and broadcast messages.
- Combine **sprites, scenes, and events** to create interactive stories and games.